Middle Stage Quick Reference

01 Contribute substance

Share relevant research and insights frequently.
Verbally cite publication and date; explain why evidence matters.
Use anecdotes to illustrate, not replace, evidence.
Avoid repetition and unrelated detours.

02 Support the group

Take notes on ideas, evidence, and their contributors; look up regularly.
Help track the round and agreed agenda periods.
Invite perspectives without repeatedly singling people out.
Redirect respectfully toward the WHAT and HOW of the task.

03 Communicate professionally

Listen actively; avoid visible frustration and distracting habits.
Address fellow discussants, not the judge.
Use concise language suited to your assigned role.
Speak clearly and maintain volume through sentence endings.

04 Manage speaking conflicts

Continue assertively only with care; it risks dominance.
Request first turn and honor your promise to yield.
Yield and request the next turn when appropriate.
Explain a timely, direct connection when requesting a turn.
If interrupted, politely finish and give the promised speaker a turn.

05 Your goal

Contribute evidence. Build on others. Keep the group moving toward a solution.